CHARACTER BOOKLET · NO. 19

Larkin Hearthstone

BAKER OF THE CANDLEWICK PUMPKIN PIES

"Twenty-four pumpkin pies, one oven, and not a single minute to spare."



FOR LARKIN HEARTHSTONE'S EYES ONLY · DO NOT SHARE THIS BOOKLET

OPTIONAL CHARACTER

JOINS AT 10+ PLAYERS

COSTUME FROM YOUR CLOSET

A white or striped apron, a sprinkle of flour on your sleeves and a rolling pin.

Mask: a pumpkin-pie mask: a paper plate painted orange with a crimped edge.

BRING TO THE BALL

- [ ] This booklet, folded shut
- [ ] A pen for your notes
- [ ] Your costume and mask

How this booklet works

Before the ball: read page 2 alone. It holds your story and your secret.

Round 1: the top half of page 3, when the Detective says so.

Round 2: the lower half of page 3, below the cut line.

Costume Parade: strike a pose and stay in character.

Round 3: page 4. Then everyone casts a ballot.

Print this booklet single-sided, or cut page 3 on its dashed line, so later rounds can't show through.

THE BALL

Every Halloween, Vesper Ravensworth opens the old candle works on the hill for the Candlewick Costume Ball. This year Vesper promised "an announcement that will change Candlewick Hollow" at nine o'clock. Before it could be made, Vesper sat down in the window chair of the Lantern Gallery and never woke up. Minutes earlier, guests saw the Lantern Ghost drift past the glass.

Never show this booklet to anyone. Bend the truth about your secret, never the evidence.

You are innocent.

You did not harm Vesper. You may still have something to hide.

> **If you are not in the game, nothing breaks.** You are an optional character: the case can be solved without you, so play for fun, share freely and enjoy your secret.

BACKGROUND

Vesper planned to give the museum café to a city bakery. Your pie stall at the ball would end.

YOUR SECRET

This year twelve of the twenty-four pies came from the supermarket. Your oven broke on Tuesday and you were too proud to say so.

WHAT YOU SAY ABOUT TONIGHT

From 8:15 to 8:55 you were alone in the kitchen, slicing pies. The kitchen is on the far side of the front hall, nowhere near the Back Stairs.

YOUR GOALS

- Keep the supermarket pies quiet until Round 3.
- Prove the kitchen is nowhere near the gallery.
- Hand out (pretend) pie to anyone who answers your questions.

HOW TO USE YOUR BOOKLET

Read each round only when the Detective starts it. Say your Share lines in your own words, ask your two questions and try your task. You may dodge questions about your secret until your booklet tells you to share it, but never lie about what you saw, and never change what an evidence card says.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 1 · *The Grand Entrance*

ROUND 1

Read only when the Detective starts Round 1.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

You were alone in the kitchen from 8:15 to 8:55, slicing twenty-four pumpkin pies for ten o'clock. The kitchen is across the front hall, nowhere near the Back Stairs. You heard the shouts about the Lantern Ghost at 8:48.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Jory Greaves:** "Were this year's pumpkins as good as last year's?"

? Ask **Hadley Cresswell:** "Who did you see in the gallery?"

YOUR TASK

> Offer everyone a (pretend) slice of pie, and note who refuses.

CUT OR FOLD HERE · ROUND 2 BELOW · WAIT FOR THE DETECTIVE

Round 2 · *The Lantern Ghost*

ROUND 2

Read only when the Detective starts Round 2.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

Vesper planned to hand the museum café to a city bakery, which would end your pie stall. You were cross, but you were going to argue, not anything worse. At 8:00 Vesper told you, "I must have it out with someone before nine."

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Marlo Quince:** "Did Vesper "have it out" with you today?"

? Ask **Bexley Applegate:** "Who fills the gallery kettle?"

YOUR TASK

> Find two people whose stories don't match.

NOTES · WHO SAID WHAT

Round 3 · *Unmasked*

Read only when the Detective starts Round 3.

SHARE THIS WITH EVERYONE

Confess the supermarket pies. Then say this: the Back Stairs come out right beside the Coat Room and the gallery kettle. Anyone coming up from the workshop floor could grab a mask and a cup in under a minute.

ASK THESE QUESTIONS

? Ask **Briar Fallow:** "Was the Coat Room busy around 8:25?"

? Ask **Corin Thimble:** "Did you see anyone leave the ballroom between 8:30 and 8:45?"

YOUR TASK

> Bake a theory: tell one person exactly how you think it was done.

Notes

SUSPECTS AT THE BALL *(public · OPT. = may not be playing)*

10 Marlo Quince · Master Chandler of Candlewick Hall

11 Darcy Wickliffe · Vesper's younger cousin and heir

12 Perry Lanthorn · Lantern-maker who lights the Lantern Gallery

13 Briar Fallow · Costume maker of Candlewick Hollow

14 Jory Greaves · Pumpkin farmer and three-time carving champion

15 Hadley Cresswell · Editor of the Hollow Gazette

16 Auden Pryor (OPT.) · Town historian and keeper of the Lantern Ghost legend

17 Bexley Applegate (OPT.) · Owner of the Applegate cider press

18 Corin Thimble (OPT.) · Fiddler and leader of the ball's band

19 Larkin Hearthstone (OPT.) · Baker of the Candlewick pumpkin pies

20 Teagan Bramwell (OPT.) · Groundskeeper of Candlewick Hall

21 Ainsley Duskwood (OPT.) · Fortune-booth performer (stage act only)

22 Merritt Oxley (OPT.) · Town clerk carrying Vesper's papers

23 Wynn Pennywhistle (OPT.) · Photographer of the Costume Parade